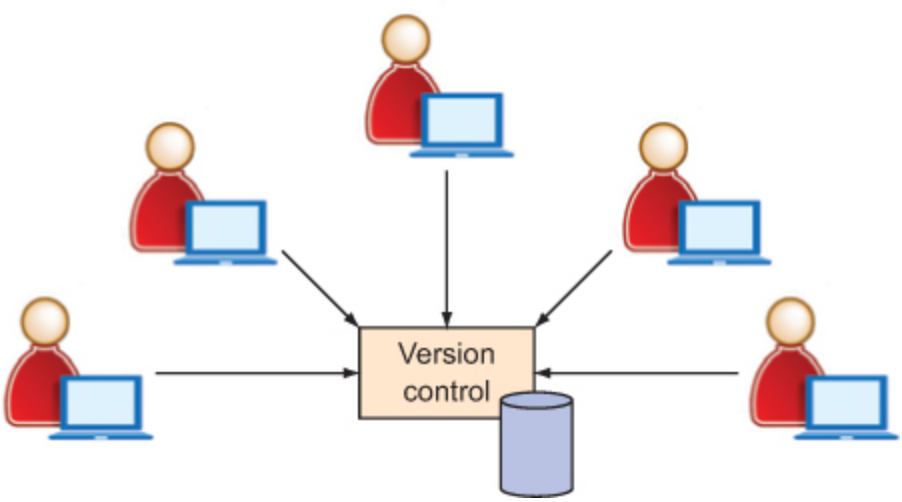


In a centralized SCM model the type of metadata that's stored along with the commit is usually just a comment. That's better than nothing, but it isn't much.

With a distributed system everyone who checks out the project then has a complete repository on their local development machine. Distributed version control systems (DVCSs) typically have individuals or groups who make significant changes to the codebase and try to merge it later. Allowing everyone to have their own history and to collaborate outside of the master repo gives a team a lot more flexibility and opportunity for distributed collaboration. A DVCS is illustrated in figure 4.4.

Figure 4.4. Distributed version control system (DVCS): everyone has a repo.